Tegra 3 has effectively brought 5 cores into play on a handheld device!

as Hummingbird or Snapdragon etc. Now processors come in single core or dual core configurations. Software too is being tweaked to make the most of dual core CPUs. These 'multi-threaded' software allocate various tasks to run parallely on two cores. Dual cores help in speeding up things, and even in multitasking. Increasing the number of cores however will increase the power consumption of a tablet. There is some amount of heating trouble being reported too.

It is also possible to have a quad-core configuration in tablets. The Tegra 3 chip developed by NVIDIA is functionally a SoC with a quad-core CPU, but includes a fifth companion core. While all cores are Cortex-A9s, the companion core is manufactured with a special low power silicon process that uses less power at low clock rate but does not scale well to high clock rates. This is a chip that one must keep an eye out for in spec sheets.

Storage Space Matters

Storage space, as in laptops and mobile phones, is measured in standard gigabytes (GB). Most tablets are available with 2GB, 4GB etc. as their on-board memory capacity. The important thing to keep in mind while selecting a tablet is whether it has an option to expand its in-built memory. So it is important to estimate the increasing memory requirements of games and apps in different OSes and then plan out your buy.

Android tablets usually provide for expandable memory with the help of SD expansion slots. Generally, a micsoSD card slot is provided in these tablets to increase the storage space. It is also very easy to transfer data to microSD card using card readers from your computers and laptops. MicroSD cards upto 32 GB are available in market.

Another important thing to keep in mind while expanding your memory is the processor speed of your tablet. Reading might be slow. Also be sure of how much the expandable memory is upgradable to. Look out for the maximum size of memory card specified on the device before buying it.